

DIGITAL

How to Write a Website Design Brief

The brief that gives a web design agency what they actually need to produce work that's right for your business.

How to Write a Website Design Brief

Most website briefs describe what the company wants visually, but not what the website needs to achieve commercially. The result is agencies solving the wrong problem beautifully. A strong website brief starts with business objectives and works backward to design requirements.

■ Business objectives first

What does the website need to achieve for the business? Be specific.

- ☐ What is the primary conversion goal? (demo request, trial signup, sales inquiry, purchase, application)
 - ☐ What is the secondary conversion goal?
 - ☐ What's the current performance baseline? (traffic, conversion rate, average session duration)
 - ☐ What are the targets for the redesigned website?
 - ☐ What's the deadline — is there a product launch, funding announcement, or event this needs to support?
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■ Audience and user intent

Who is visiting the website and what are they trying to accomplish when they arrive?

- ☐ Who are the primary visitors? (demographics, job roles, stage in the buying process)
 - ☐ What do they know about your company before arriving?
 - ☐ What question are they trying to answer?
 - ☐ What objection do they have that the website needs to overcome?
 - ☐ Who makes the final purchase decision — the visitor, or someone they need to convince?
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■ Content requirements

What content does the website need to contain — and what content will you actually be able to produce?

- ☐ Site map: what pages are required?
 - ☐ What existing content can be reused vs. what needs to be produced from scratch?
 - ☐ Who is responsible for producing new content?
 - ☐ Do you need video? Photography? Illustration? And who produces those?
 - ☐ How often will content be updated, and does the site need a CMS?
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■ Technical requirements

The constraints and integrations the website needs to work with.

- ☐ What CMS or platform is required?
- ☐ What third-party tools need to integrate? (CRM, analytics, chat, marketing automation)
- ☐ What are the performance requirements? (target Lighthouse scores, page speed targets)

- ☐ Is there an existing tech stack the website needs to fit within?
 - ☐ What are the hosting and security requirements?
 - ☐ What accessibility level is required (WCAG AA or AAA)?
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| Brand requirements

What brand assets and guidelines does the agency need to work with?

- ☐ Is there an existing brand identity to follow, or is the brand being developed simultaneously?
 - ☐ Are there brand guidelines to share?
 - ☐ What existing brand assets are available?
 - ☐ Are there design elements (logo, colours, type) that must be carried over?
 - ☐ Are there visual references for the direction you want the website to take?
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| Budget and timeline

Be direct about both. Agencies that receive vague budget signals will either over-scope or scope-protect in ways that don't serve your project.

- ☐ Total budget for the project, including design and development
 - ☐ Whether ongoing support is included or a separate discussion
 - ☐ Launch deadline and any intermediate milestones
 - ☐ How decision-making will work internally (who has approval authority at each phase?)
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